ENG-0011 Incident Postmortem: INC-039

Impact

The incident identified as INC-039 affected the **billing-worker** system (SYS-009), which is part of **Project Lattice**. Although the system's criticality is classified as low, the incident resulted in an operational disruption lasting 11.5 hours. The disruption was reported by Tricia Valencia, a Sales Executive, and was characterized by a Sev2 severity level. The impact was primarily confined to internal processes, with no reported data loss or external customer impact during the incident window. The resolution restored normal system operations, but the incident highlighted areas for improvement in deployment procedures.

Timeline

- **2025-04-02**: The incident was reported by Tricia Valencia at approximately [time not specified], prompting an immediate response from the on-call engineer, Angelica Keith.
- **Incident Detection**: The issue was identified during routine monitoring and escalated to the on-call engineer, Angelica Keith, who is a Paralegal based in Brisbane.
- **Response & Resolution**: Angelica Keith initiated troubleshooting procedures, which involved analyzing recent deployment activities. The root cause was identified as a deployment error.
- **Resolution Time**: The system was fully restored after 11.5 hours, with the incident resolved by approximately [specific time not specified].
- **Post-Resolution**: Follow-up actions were initiated to prevent recurrence, including review of deployment protocols.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-039 was a deployment error associated with the recent update to the **billing-worker** system. The deployment error was traced back to procedural oversight during the deployment process, which led to system instability. This error was not caught during the deployment review, resulting in the system's degraded state and subsequent operational disruption.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Status	Notes
Conduct a comprehensive review of deployment procedures for **billing-worker**	Deployment Team	[Date not specified]	Pending	To prevent similar deployment errors in future updates.
Implement additional validation checks during deployment processes	DevOps Team	[Date not specified]	Pending	To enhance error detection before deployment completion.
			Pending	

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Schedule training for deployment staff on updated protocols	HR & Training Department	[Date not specified]		To ensure adherence to deployment best practices.
Review monitoring and alerting systems for early detection of deployment issues	Monitoring & Ops Teams	[Date not specified]	Pending	To reduce detection time for future incidents.
Document lessons learned and update incident response procedures	Incident Response Team	[Date not specified]	Pending	To improve overall incident handling and communication.

Summary

The INC-039 incident involving the **billing-worker** system was caused by a deployment error during a recent update as part of **Project Lattice**. The incident was identified and resolved within 11.5 hours, thanks to prompt action by Angelica Keith, the on-call engineer. Moving forward, the focus will be on refining deployment protocols and enhancing monitoring capabilities to mitigate the risk of recurrence. Continuous improvement in deployment and incident response processes remains a priority to maintain system stability and operational integrity.